SOFTWARE BLUEPRINT · PHASE 1

Requirements Discovery

Business, system and access baseline for the proposed Usiri Marketplace

Working name only — no Usiri affiliation is implied.

Prepared for: the founding group
Document: UM-DISC-001 · **Version:** 0.2
Date: 30 October 2026
Author: project initiator

DISCOVERY ONLY. No implementation is authorized. Usiri is a potential logistics and brand partner, not a confirmed one. No API, rate card, franchise term, supplier commitment or funding commitment is assumed.

CONFIDENTIAL — FOR INTERNAL DISCUSSION

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0. Document control and status

Field	Value
Document	Requirements Discovery Report
Project	Usiri Marketplace (working name)
Document ID	UM-DISC-001
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Status	**Draft for founder review. Decisions D-01 to D-04 recorded 30 October 2026. No implementation is authorized.**
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Related documents	`Usiri_Marketplace_Project_Concept.md` v1.0; `Group_Meeting_Pack.md` ; `Startup_Budget_and_Decision_Workbook.xlsx` ; `01_Decision_Log.md` v0.2; `03_Decision_Outcome_and_Scope_Amendment.md` v1.0
Next document	Business Requirements Document (BRD) and Software Requirements Specification (SRS), using the amended scope

> **Status notice.** Usiri Group of Companies is a **potential** logistics and brand partner, not a confirmed partner. This report does not assume that Usiri has approved the project, has an API, has a rate card, or has agreed to any franchise or brand licence. No code has been written. No supplier, carrier, payment provider or customer has committed to anything.

> **Amendment notice — 30 October 2026.** The founders answered the four blocking decisions. **D-01 was answered differently from the recommendation in this report:** the first release is **general merchandise**, not the focused home-and-kitchen pilot. D-02, D-03 and D-04 were accepted as recommended. The consequences are issued separately as **UM-AMD-001, Decision Outcome and Scope Amendment**, which supersedes the scope statements in Section 3 and the DEC-01 entry in Section 14. Where this report and UM-AMD-001 differ on launch scope, UM-AMD-001 governs. The analysis in Sections 4 to 13 remains valid; the scope-dependent parts are restated in the amendment.

0.1 How evidence is labelled

Label	Meaning
[Confirmed]	Stated in the project brief or agreed by the founders. It can be designed against.
[Assumption]	A planning assumption taken from the concept document. It must be tested before it becomes a requirement.
[Proposed]	A design recommendation in this report. It is not yet approved.

Label	Meaning
[Open]	A decision or fact that is unresolved. It is listed with an owner and an impact.
[To verify]	A claim, usually from a company or a secondary source, that has not been independently checked.

1. Purpose, scope and method

1.1 Purpose

This report converts the proposed Usiri Marketplace concept into a structured discovery baseline: what the business is trying to achieve, who is involved, what the system must do at launch, which rules govern money and trust, what quality attributes matter, which legal obligations shape the design, and what remains unknown.

It is the input to the BRD and SRS. It is not the BRD, the SRS, the architecture document or the database design. Those documents come after the founders confirm the scope decisions in Section 14.

1.2 What this report is not

- It is not an approval to build, recruit, sign supplier agreements, approach payment providers as a merchant, or represent the project as a Usiri project.
- It is not a substitute for legal, tax, accounting or regulatory advice. Tanzanian counsel and a qualified accountant must review the positions marked **[Open]**.
- It is not a market study. The concept document already sets out the customer, supplier and carrier evidence still required.
- It is not a final technology selection. The brief proposes a stack; this report treats it as a strong default, not a commitment.

1.3 Inputs

1. **The project brief** supplied by the founders: a multi-vendor marketplace, a proposed franchise relationship with Usiri, provider-agnostic logistics, authorised payment providers, configurable branding, and a phased engineering process. **[Confirmed]**
2. **The concept document v1.0**, especially the business model (Section 4), journeys (Section 7), initial segment (Section 8), revenue model (Section 9), logistics (Section 10), technology direction (Section 11), legal map (Section 12) and MVP definition (Section 17). **[Confirmed as project intent]**
3. **Desk review of Tanzanian regulation** recorded in the concept document’s source register. The sources are secondary summaries unless they are primary legislation or an official regulator page; they are cited in Appendix B and must be checked by counsel. **[To verify]**
4. **No primary field research has been completed**: no supplier interviews, customer interviews, carrier quotations, payment provider proposals or legal opinions are in hand. This is the largest evidence gap in the project and is treated as such throughout.

1.4 Method

The discovery followed six steps:

1. Decompose the brief into business objectives and scope boundaries.
2. Identify every actor, including actors who never log in but whose data or decisions enter the system.
3. Build a preliminary role and permission model from least privilege and separation of duties.
4. Map capabilities and the workflows that cross them, starting with the hardest case: one checkout spanning several suppliers.
5. Separate business rules, quality attributes and regulatory drivers so that they can be traced to requirements and tests later.

6. Record every unknown as a gap or an open decision, with an owner, a method and the impact of leaving it unresolved.

1.5 A note on precision

The report uses **must** for what the launch system is required to do, **should** for a strong expectation that may be traded against time, and **may** for an optional capability. These words are not decoration; they are the basis for acceptance testing in the SRS.

Where the concept document uses a planning number, such as an 8% commission or 900 orders in month six, this report labels it an assumption. A planning number is not a requirement. The system must make the number configurable; it must not hard-code it.

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2. Business objectives and value proposition

2.1 The proposition in one paragraph

The marketplace lets a customer in Dar es Salaam buy everyday home, kitchen and small electrical goods from several verified shops in one checkout, pay through a licensed provider, receive a tracked delivery, and get a refund or replacement when something goes wrong. The platform earns a commission on completed sales, a supplier subscription and a delivery coordination fee; it does not buy stock, own vehicles or hold customer funds. **[Confirmed direction, Assumption on segment]**

2.2 Business objectives

ID	Objective	Why it matters	How the pilot knows	Link to concept
OBJ-01	Prove that customers will buy from several verified suppliers through one checkout	Demand is the first risk; without orders nothing else can be tested	900 completed orders in pilot month 6	Section 3.4
OBJ-02	Deliver reliably enough that customers trust the platform with repeat purchases	A late or lost parcel destroys trust faster than price attracts it	At least 90% on-time delivery; first-attempt success at least 80%	Section 10.8
OBJ-03	Resolve failures fairly and quickly	The first exception is the moment of truth	90% of complaints resolved within 48 hours; returns below 5%	Section 7.4
OBJ-04	Recruit and retain credible suppliers	Supply quality determines catalogue quality and returns	40 verified suppliers by month 3; 80% retention after 90 days	Section 8.5
OBJ-05	Prove positive contribution economics	Growth on negative unit economics destroys the company faster	Contribution at least 4% of gross order value by month 6	Section 9
OBJ-06	Operate within Tanzanian law and the platform’s contracts	A compliance failure can stop trading and damage the brand	Written legal baseline; registrations and filings completed as advised	Section 12
OBJ-07	Run the pilot with a small team without operational chaos	The team, not the software, is the constraint at launch	Every pilot order handled through the system; no shadow spreadsheets for money	Section 17.1
OBJ-08	Produce evidence for a scale, pivot or stop decision	The pilot exists to buy information, not to prove a point	Documented go/no-go review at month 6	Section 19

2.3 Value by participant

Participant	Value if the model works	What they give up or risk
Customer	One place to find verified household goods, transparent total price, tracked delivery, a remedy when something fails	A delivery fee, sharing an address and phone number, waiting for delivery instead of buying in person
Supplier	Demand, photography and catalogue help, delivery coordination, a payment process, and a customer-service buffer	Commission, service standards, stock accuracy, packing work, return exposure when at fault

Participant	Value if the model works	What they give up or risk
Carrier	Predictable parcel volume, consolidated pickups or drop-offs, digital manifests and labels	Service-level commitments, tracking discipline, liability for loss and damage under its terms
Payment provider	Transaction volume and merchant fees	Must satisfy its own onboarding, risk and settlement rules; the platform cannot ask it to bend licensing rules
Franchise or brand partner	Brand reach and a new channel without building the technology	Reputational exposure if service fails; brand standards must be enforceable
Founders	A chance to build a defensible operating business with modest fixed assets	Time, reputational capital, legal exposure, and the risk that the market does not respond

2.4 Revenue lines and the rule that protects them

The concept proposes four revenue lines: commission on completed sales, supplier subscriptions, a delivery coordination fee, and sponsored placement later. **[Assumption]**

Three rules follow for the software:

1. **Pass-through money is not revenue.** Carrier charges, supplier goods value and refunded amounts must be recorded separately from commission, subscription and coordination revenue.
2. **Commission follows completion, not capture.** Commission is earned on net merchandise value after discounts and returns, not on the amount first collected.
3. **Every revenue line is configurable and effective-dated.** A rate change must not silently rewrite historical orders.

2.5 What must be true

The concept document names six conditions: customers pay for reliability, suppliers accept the commission and rules, delivery can be bought at a predictable rate, returns stay below 5%, fixed costs stay lean, and ancillary revenue is real. **[Assumption]** If the first four fail together, the business model does not work, and no amount of software fixes it. The discovery process therefore treats supplier and customer willingness as **blocking evidence**, not as background research.

3. Scope boundary

> **Superseded in part — see UM-AMD-001.** Sections 3.1 and 3.2 below record the scope recommendation made before the founders decided. The **decided** launch scope is general merchandise, bounded to six departments: homeware, storage and kitchenware; small kitchen and home appliances; fashion and footwear; beauty and personal care; baby and maternity; and home and kitchen bundles. Forty verified suppliers and 800–1,200 SKUs at launch, rising to 60 suppliers by month six. Section 3.3 (operating constraints) and Section 3.4 (scope change rule) remain in force. The full amended scope, category price bands, variant requirements and the added rules, gaps and risks are in UM-AMD-001.

3.1 In scope for the first release

The first release is the smallest system that lets a real customer buy from several real suppliers, pay by mobile money or card through a licensed provider, receive a tracked delivery, and obtain a refund. It includes:

- A mobile-first customer web application (responsive site or PWA) in Swahili and English.
- Guest checkout and optional customer accounts.
- A supplier portal for onboarding, catalogue, stock, orders, dispatch and statements.
- An operations and administration console for verification, moderation, orders, payments, payouts, logistics, returns, support and reporting.
- A logistics coordination module that works manually at pilot and is provider-agnostic.
- Payment integration through an authorised payment service provider (PSP), with reconciliation and refunds.
- A support and dispute workflow with order context.
- Audit logging, role-based access control and the legal pages needed at checkout.

3.2 Explicitly out of scope for the first release

Excluded	Reason	Revisit when
Native iOS and Android applications	Web/PWA reaches more people at lower cost; app reviews add delay	Repeat purchase and traffic justify the cost
Marketplace-owned warehouse or dark store	Contradicts the asset-light model and adds fixed cost	Supplier density or delivery density makes consolidation economic
Marketplace-owned fleet	Capital and operational burden; carriers are licensed for this	Volume and route density justify it, if ever
Real-time GPS tracking	Carrier capability unknown; status events are enough for the promise	A carrier offers reliable event data and customers demand it
Customer wallet, credit or instalments	Licensing, fraud and float risk	Licensed partner and proven fraud controls
Buyer-seller chat	Disintermediation, abuse and moderation cost	Never in the current model
Multi-city operations	Operations must be proven in one city first	Expansion criteria in concept Section 8.6 are met for two consecutive months
International shipping and multi-currency	Customs, tax and delivery complexity	After domestic model is profitable
AI recommendations and personalisation	No behavioural data; adds cost and privacy surface	Catalogue and traffic are large enough to matter

Excluded	Reason	Revisit when
Automated supplier payouts	Manual approval is safer while volumes are low	Reconciliation is stable and payout volume justifies automation
Microservices and event streaming	Complexity without measured need	A measured bottleneck cannot be solved inside the monolith
Advertising auction and loyalty programme	No traffic or repeat base yet	After 12 months of stable operations, if ever

3.3 Operating constraints

- **One city, one currency.** Dar es Salaam; Tanzanian shillings. **[Assumption]**
- **One legal entity owns the platform and its contracts.** The founders establish the operating company. **[Confirmed]**
- **No platform-held customer funds.** Payment collection and settlement run through an authorised provider; the platform does not operate an informal escrow or deposit scheme. **[Confirmed]**
- **No Usiri dependency in the critical path.** The system must work with any qualified carrier and must not contain a hard-coded Usiri integration. **[Confirmed]**
- **Brand and franchise rules are configuration, not code.** Territory, fee display, brand assets and approval rules must be data-driven. **[Confirmed]**
- **Small team.** The pilot assumes one technical lead, one developer, a part-time designer and an operations lead. **[Assumption]**

3.4 Scope change rule

A capability enters the first release only if it is required to complete, deliver, refund or support a pilot order, or to meet a legal obligation. Everything else is deferred, however attractive. This rule is deliberately strict because the most common MVP failure is not a missing feature; it is a system the team cannot operate.

4. Stakeholder analysis

4.1 Stakeholder register

ID	Stakeholder	Primary interest	Responsibility	Interaction with the system	Influence / interest
STK-01	Guest visitor	Browse without committing; understand price and delivery before registering	None beyond lawful use	Catalogue, search, cart, guest checkout	Low influence, high interest
STK-02	Registered customer	Buy reliably, track orders, return items, get help	Keep contact and address accurate; pay; collect parcel	Account, orders, returns, reviews, tickets	Medium influence, high interest
STK-03	Individual merchant	Sell more without hiring a delivery desk	List accurately, keep stock current, pack to standard	Supplier portal, orders, statements	Medium influence, high interest
STK-04	Business supplier	A predictable channel that protects its reputation	Contract, compliance, product quality, fulfilment	Supplier portal plus commercial reporting	High influence on supply, high interest
STK-05	Supplier employee	Clear daily tasks without exposure to sensitive data	Pack, dispatch, respond to order alerts	Limited supplier sub-account	Low influence, medium interest
STK-06	Logistics provider	Profitable, predictable parcel volume	Pickup, line-haul, delivery, status events, claims	Carrier portal or manual coordination; adapter later	High influence on delivery promise
STK-07	Logistics agent or driver	Clear stops and proof of delivery	Collect and deliver; record status and POD	Mobile-friendly status page or carrier app	Low influence, high interest
STK-08	Customer support agent	Resolve issues quickly with full context	Triage, communicate, escalate, document	Support console, order context, refunds requests	High influence on trust
STK-09	Finance personnel	Accurate money, timely payouts, clean reconciliation	Reconcile, approve payouts, process refunds, report	Payments, ledger, settlements, reports	High influence, high interest
STK-10	Catalogue moderator	A trustworthy, accurate catalogue	Review listings, categories, images, claims	Moderation queue, product records	Medium influence
STK-11	Operations administrator	Orders move and exceptions close	Book carriers, monitor dispatch, resolve exceptions	Operations console, shipment records	High influence on service
STK-12	Super administrator	The platform is controlled and auditable	Manage staff, roles, configuration, sensitive approvals	Full administration, audit logs	High influence
STK-13	Franchise or brand manager	Brand standards and licence compliance	Approve brand use, review reports, audit standards	Brand configuration, compliance reports	High influence if a licence exists; currently none

ID	Stakeholder	Primary interest	Responsibility	Interaction with the system	Influence / interest
STK-14	Technology administrator	A secure, available system	Deploy, monitor, patch, restore	Infrastructure, logs, configuration	High influence, low business-data interest
STK-15	Auditor or adviser	Evidence that controls work	Review records, test controls, report	Read-only audit and financial views	Low influence, high interest
STK-16	Regulators and authorities	Compliance with applicable law	Investigate, license, enforce, advise	Legal requests outside normal product access	High influence, episodic

4.2 External systems as dependencies

Dependency	What the platform needs	What is confirmed	Risk if unavailable
Payment service provider	Merchant onboarding, collection, refunds, settlement reports, webhooks, reconciliation file	Nothing	No way to take payment lawfully at scale
Carrier	Rate card, booking, waybill, tracking events, POD, claims, liability terms	Nothing; Usiri publishes no API or rate card	Delivery promise cannot be costed or tracked
SMS gateway	Sender ID, delivery receipts, OTP delivery	Nothing	Customers cannot verify or receive updates
WhatsApp Business provider	Template approval, message delivery	Nothing	Reduced communication channel, not fatal
Object storage and CDN	Image and document storage, signed URLs	Vendor selection open	Catalogue and KYC documents cannot be stored safely
Hosting and database	Managed runtime, backups, private networking	Vendor selection open	No production environment
Identity or KYC service	Document checks and liveness, where used	Nothing	Manual verification remains the fallback
Accounting or ERP	Export of sales, commission, payouts and tax lines	Nothing	Manual journal preparation; error risk
Email provider	Transactional email and support	Nothing	Minor, SMS remains primary

4.3 Governance and decision rights (preliminary)

Decision	Proposed authority	Consultation	Notes
Product scope and MVP trade-offs	CEO or product owner	CTO, operations lead	Documented in the decision log
Architecture and security standards	CTO or technical lead	CEO, external reviewer for high-risk changes	No production change without review
Supplier approval or suspension	Operations lead	Finance if money is at risk	Suspension is a sensitive action requiring a reason
Refund above threshold	Finance lead	CEO above a higher threshold	Thresholds to be set before pilot

Decision	Proposed authority	Consultation	Notes
Supplier payout batch	Finance preparer plus second approver	CEO for exceptions	Maker-checker is mandatory
Brand or franchise commitments	Founders unanimously	Legal counsel	No individual may sign alone
Data access for staff	Super administrator	CTO	Time-bound, logged, reason required
Regulatory filings	Finance and compliance owner	Counsel	Calendar with evidence of submission

5. Preliminary role and access model

5.1 Principles

1. **Deny by default.** A role receives only the permissions explicitly granted to it.
2. **Least privilege.** Access is limited to the data and actions needed for the task, not to the department.
3. **Separation of duties.** The person who prepares a payout cannot be the only person who approves it.
4. **Field-level protection.** A supplier sees the delivery name, phone and address needed to pack and hand over, but not the customer's order history, payment details or other suppliers' data.
5. **Scoped queries.** Every supplier, carrier and customer query is filtered by tenant ownership at the data-access layer, not only in the interface.
6. **Audit everything sensitive.** Role changes, refunds, payouts, price overrides, supplier suspension and data exports are recorded with actor, time, reason and before/after values.
7. **No shared accounts.** Staff accounts are individual; break-glass access is time-bound and reviewed.

5.2 Role catalogue

ID	Role	Scope
ROL-01	Guest	Unauthenticated visitor with a temporary cart
ROL-02	Customer	Registered buyer acting on their own account
ROL-03	Supplier owner	Legal owner or authorised manager of one supplier account
ROL-04	Supplier staff	Employee of one supplier with task-level permissions
ROL-05	Logistics provider administrator	Administrator of one carrier organisation
ROL-06	Logistics agent or driver	Field user assigned to specific shipments or stops
ROL-07	Support agent	Customer-service staff with order and ticket access
ROL-08	Finance personnel	Staff responsible for payments, refunds, reconciliation and payouts
ROL-09	Catalogue moderator	Staff responsible for product and category quality
ROL-10	Operations administrator	Staff responsible for order and shipment operations
ROL-11	Super administrator	Platform owner role for configuration and sensitive approvals
ROL-12	Franchise or brand manager	Brand-licence representative with compliance visibility only
ROL-13	Technology administrator	Infrastructure and deployment role without default business-data access
ROL-14	Auditor	Read-only review role for controls and records

5.3 Permission matrix

The matrix states the **maximum** permission of the role. A specific user may be granted less, never more, without a super-administrator decision and an audit record.

Role	View	Create	Edit	Approve	Delete	Explicitly cannot
ROL-01 Guest	Published catalogue, storefronts, policies, delivery estimate	Cart session, guest checkout, support enquiry	Own cart only	Nothing	Own cart items	View any placed order, customer record, supplier record, payment data or internal note
ROL-02 Customer	Own profile, addresses, orders, returns, tickets, own reviews	Order, return request, ticket, review, saved address	Own profile and address before dispatch; own review within edit window	Nothing	Own saved address or wishlist item	See another customer, supplier cost or margin, internal notes, or staff data
ROL-03 Supplier owner	Own store, products, stock, own supplier orders and fulfilment fields, own statements, own scorecard	Product, variant, price, stock update, dispatch request, promotion request, staff invitation	Own catalogue, stock, store profile, order preparation fields	Nothing financial or platform-wide	Archive own product; remove own draft	See other suppliers, full customer profiles, commission configuration, platform reports, another store's payouts
ROL-04 Supplier staff	Assigned store products and orders needed for packing	Draft product, stock adjustment, dispatch status	Stock, order preparation, own profile	Nothing	Nothing	See payout account, contract, commission rate, customer history, other suppliers, staff roles
ROL-05 Logistics provider administrator	Assigned shipments, own service areas and rates, own performance report	Shipment acceptance, status event, claim, service area proposal	Own shipment status and POD, own profile	Nothing commercial	Nothing in production	See order prices, commissions, customer payment data, other carriers, platform margin
ROL-06 Logistics agent or driver	Assigned stops and recipient contact needed to deliver	Status event, POD, failed-attempt reason	Assigned delivery data only	Nothing	Nothing	Browse all orders, see order value, customer history or payment information
ROL-07 Support agent	Customer and order context, tickets, returns, masked payment status	Ticket, return request, refund request, internal note	Ticket status and notes, contact details with reason	Nothing financial	Nothing	Approve refunds or payouts, change commission, export full customer database, view full card data
ROL-08 Finance	Payments, ledger, refunds, payouts, reconciliation, financial reports	Payout batch, refund record, journal adjustment request	Draft financial records before approval	Refund and payout within delegated limit	Nothing	Edit catalogue, change supplier KYC except finance fields, alter audit logs, approve own adjustment
ROL-09 Catalogue moderator	Products, categories, brands, moderation queue, supplier quality flags	Category, brand, moderation note	Listing metadata and moderation status	Approve or reject listing	Archive listing only	See customer PII, payments, payouts, supplier bank details
ROL-10 Operations administrator	Orders, shipments, supplier operations, exceptions, carrier performance	Carrier booking, shipment record, supplier task, exception case	Order operations fields, carrier assignment, promised date with reason	Nothing financial	Nothing	Approve payouts, change commission, view full KYC unless operationally required
ROL-11 Super administrator	All business data and configuration, audit logs	Staff account, role, configuration, promotion, category	Any business record subject to change control	Sensitive actions with a second approver	Soft-delete or archive only	Delete audit logs, approve own financial adjustment alone, access production secrets without break-glass
ROL-12 Franchise or brand manager	Brand assets, brand compliance reports, aggregate commercial reports	Brand content within licence scope	Brand settings within licence scope	Brand usage approval	Nothing	See customer PII, supplier contracts, individual orders, payout amounts
ROL-13 Technology administrator	Infrastructure, deployment status, logs, configuration, error traces	Service account, environment, deployment	System configuration through change process	Deploy through change approval	Nothing business-critical	Read customer PII or financial records without break-glass approval; alter audit records
ROL-14 Auditor	Audit logs, financial records, policies, control evidence	Nothing	Nothing	Nothing	Nothing	Edit any record; view unmasked customer PII beyond what the audit purpose requires

5.4 Sensitive data classes

Class	Examples	Default handling	Roles with access
Identity and KYC	National ID, business registration, TIN, beneficial owner, site-visit evidence	Encrypted at rest; private object storage; signed URLs; access logged	Supplier owner for own documents; ROL-08, ROL-11, ROL-14; ROL-10 only when required
Contact and address	Name, phone, delivery address, landmark, alternate recipient	Masked in lists; revealed to assigned supplier and carrier only for fulfilment	ROL-02 for own data; ROL-03 and ROL-05 for assigned orders; ROL-07 with reason; ROL-08 where needed
Order and commercial	Items, prices, discounts, commission, delivery cost, margin	Supplier sees own order lines and its commission, not platform-wide margin	ROL-02 own orders; ROL-03 own orders; ROL-07, ROL-08, ROL-10, ROL-11
Payment	PSP reference, amount, status, refunds, settlement	No card data stored; PSP token or reference only	ROL-08, ROL-11, ROL-14 masked; customer sees own status
Credentials and secrets	Password hashes, API keys, webhook secrets	Managed secret store; never in source or logs	ROL-13 through controlled process only
Audit and security	Login history, admin actions, access reasons	Append-only; restricted read	ROL-14, ROL-11, ROL-13 for security events

5.5 Segregation of duties

Activity	Preparer	Approver	Rule
Supplier payout	Finance	Second finance user or CEO	Same person cannot prepare and approve
Refund above threshold	Support or finance	Finance lead	Threshold set before pilot; above it, CEO
Supplier suspension	Operations	Super administrator	Written reason and evidence
Commission or fee change	Finance or CEO	Founders or delegated owner	Effective date required; no retroactive change without approval
Role or permission change	Super administrator	Second founder	Logged with before/after
Production data access	Technology administrator	Super administrator break-glass approval	Time-bound; session recorded
Brand or franchise commitment	Founders	Unanimous founders plus counsel	No unilateral signature

5.6 Authentication requirements (draft)

- Customers authenticate by phone number with a one-time code; email and password may be offered as an alternative. **[Proposed]**
- Staff and suppliers require a password plus multi-factor authentication. **[Proposed]**
- Supplier staff accounts are invited by the supplier owner and can be revoked immediately. **[Proposed]**
- Sessions expire after inactivity; sensitive actions require re-authentication. **[Proposed]**
- Login, OTP and password-reset attempts are rate-limited and monitored. **[Proposed]**
- All authentication events are logged without recording secrets or full OTP values. **[Proposed]**

5.7 Open access questions

ID	Question	Impact
O-RBAC-01	Will suppliers be allowed to create sub-users at launch, or only after pilot?	Affects supplier onboarding and support load
O-RBAC-02	Should support agents see full customer phone numbers or a masked value with a reveal action?	Balances service speed against data minimisation
O-RBAC-03	Does the franchise or brand partner need any access to individual orders, or only aggregate compliance reports?	Affects tenant model and data-sharing agreement
O-RBAC-04	Is a separate auditor account required by any investor, lender or regulator?	Affects evidence export and access review
O-RBAC-05	What is the refund approval threshold for finance and for the CEO?	Needed before pilot, not before build

6. Capability map and module inventory

6.1 Capability map

Priority: **Must** means required for the pilot; **Should** means planned shortly after launch; **Later** means explicitly deferred.

ID	Capability	What it must cover	Priority and dependencies
CAP-01	Identity, authentication and consent	Customer, supplier and staff accounts; phone verification; MFA for staff; sessions; consent records; role assignment	Must. Foundation for every other capability
CAP-02	Supplier onboarding and KYC	Application, document upload, verification workflow, site visit, contract record, approval, suspension, re-verification	Must. Depends on CAP-01 and document storage
CAP-03	Catalogue and moderation	Products, variants, categories, attributes, brands, images, pricing, approval, visibility, prohibited-item checks	Must. Depends on CAP-02
CAP-04	Inventory and availability	Stock per variant, reservation, release, low-stock alerts, suppression at zero, supplier stock updates	Must. Depends on CAP-03
CAP-05	Search, browse and discovery	Keyword search, category browse, filters, sort, related products, zero-result handling	Must. Depends on CAP-03
CAP-06	Cart and checkout	Multi-supplier cart, price and stock validation, address, delivery quote, fees, payment selection, order submission	Must. Depends on CAP-04, CAP-05, CAP-10
CAP-07	Orders and fulfilment orchestration	Parent order, supplier sub-orders, items, statuses, cancellations, partial fulfilment, event history	Must. Depends on CAP-06
CAP-08	Payments and reconciliation	Payment initiation, callback verification, idempotency, ledger, refunds, reconciliation, mismatch handling	Must. Depends on CAP-07 and a PSP agreement
CAP-09	Settlements and supplier payouts	Commission calculation, statements, holds, payout batches, dual approval, adjustments, export	Must. Depends on CAP-08
CAP-10	Logistics and tracking	Provider register, service areas, rates, shipment records, labels, booking, status events, POD, exceptions, claims	Must, with manual mode. API adapter later
CAP-11	Returns, refunds and disputes	Return request, eligibility, evidence, approval, reverse logistics, inspection, refund calculation, supplier chargeback, dispute	Must. Depends on CAP-07, CAP-08, CAP-10
CAP-12	Customer support	Ticket queue, order context, assignment, internal notes, escalation, SLA timers, resolution	Must. Depends on CAP-07
CAP-13	Notifications	SMS, WhatsApp and email templates; event triggers; delivery status; failure handling; consent-aware marketing	Must. Depends on CAP-01, CAP-07
CAP-14	Administration and governance	Staff, roles, permissions, configuration, approvals, audit logs, data export, feature flags	Must. Depends on CAP-01
CAP-15	Reporting and analytics	Orders, GMV, revenue, contribution, returns, delivery performance, supplier scorecards, cohort retention	Must for basic reports; Should for cohorts
CAP-16	Reviews and ratings	Verified-buyer reviews, moderation, supplier reply, abuse reporting	Should. Depends on CAP-07
CAP-17	Promotions and sponsored placement	Vouchers, supplier-funded discounts, campaign tracking, sponsored slots	Should for vouchers; Later for auction
CAP-18	Franchise and brand configuration	Brand assets, territory rules, fee display, approval workflow, compliance reports	Must if a licence is signed; otherwise configurable but inactive

6.2 Dependency order

The build order is constrained by data dependencies, not by screen count:

1. Identity, roles, consent and audit (CAP-01, CAP-14).
2. Supplier onboarding and catalogue (CAP-02, CAP-03, CAP-04).
3. Customer discovery, cart and checkout (CAP-05, CAP-06).
4. Orders, payments and ledger (CAP-07, CAP-08).
5. Logistics and fulfilment (CAP-10).
6. Returns, support and settlements (CAP-11, CAP-12, CAP-09).
7. Reporting, reviews and promotions (CAP-15, CAP-16, CAP-17).

A team that builds checkout before supplier verification and stock reservation will create orders the platform cannot fulfil. A team that builds payments before the order and ledger model will create reconciliation debt from the first transaction.

6.3 Requirements status convention

Every capability will be decomposed in the SRS into requirements with an ID, a statement, a priority, a source and an acceptance criterion. The discovery baseline does not yet assign thousands of low-level requirements. It establishes the modules, rules and quality attributes that those requirements must respect.

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7. Critical end-to-end workflows

7.1 WF-01: Customer purchase across several suppliers

Actors: guest or customer, marketplace, PSP, supplier sub-orders, carrier.

1. Customer browses or searches; results show price, stock status, seller and delivery promise.
2. Customer adds items from one or more suppliers to a single cart.
3. At cart and checkout, the platform revalidates price and stock server-side. It does not trust the browser.
4. Customer enters a phone number and delivery address, including a landmark. The platform validates the zone and shows the delivery fee and total before payment.
5. The platform creates a payment intent with a unique idempotency key and a reference that can be reconciled.
6. The customer pays through the PSP. The platform never treats the browser’s success message as proof of payment.
7. On a verified callback or server-side status query, the platform creates the parent order and supplier sub-orders, reserves stock, and records the payment.
8. The customer sees one order number and one support thread. Each supplier sees only its sub-order and the fulfilment data it needs.
9. Notifications confirm the order and set expectations for split deliveries.
10. If payment fails, stock is released, the cart remains recoverable and no order is created. If stock is lost between checkout and payment confirmation, the affected line is cancelled and refunded before the rest proceeds.

Failure paths that must be designed: duplicate submission, delayed callback, callback received before the order record is committed, payment succeeded but stock reservation failed, address outside the zone, one supplier rejecting while others accept, and a customer closing the browser after paying.

7.2 WF-02: Supplier fulfilment

1. Supplier receives an order alert by SMS, WhatsApp, email or dashboard, according to preference.
2. Supplier accepts or rejects within a stated window. Rejection requires a reason code and releases the line for refund.
3. On acceptance, the supplier prepares the parcel to the packaging standard, prints the packing slip and label, and marks it ready for handover.
4. Operations or the carrier records the handover: time, parcel count, weight, condition and waybill.
5. The shipment moves through carrier status events until delivery or a failed attempt.
6. The supplier sees its own service metrics: acceptance rate, on-time handover, cancellation rate, return rate and unresolved complaints.

Control: the platform must not allow a supplier to mark an order delivered. Delivery is a carrier or operations event with evidence. The supplier can mark ready for handover, not delivered.

7.3 WF-03: Payment verification and reconciliation

1. The platform creates a payment intent with amount, currency, order reference, customer reference and idempotency key.
2. The PSP returns a redirect or push prompt. The customer completes payment in the PSP channel.
3. The PSP sends a callback. The platform verifies the signature, timestamp and reference, then retrieves the authoritative status from the PSP server-to-server.

4. The platform writes a payment record and double-entry ledger entries. It updates the order only after the authoritative status is `paid`.
5. A scheduled reconciliation job compares the platform ledger with the PSP settlement report by reference and amount.
6. Mismatches enter an exception queue with an owner. They are never silently adjusted.
7. Refunds are initiated against the original payment, recorded separately, and reconciled on the same schedule.

Rules: idempotency on initiation and callback; no client-side trust; no card data stored; every money movement has a reference; reconciliation exceptions are visible to finance; failed or reversed payments release stock and notify the customer.

7.4 WF-04: Manual logistics at pilot (Mode A)

The carrier may have no API, no rate card and no working tracking page. The pilot therefore runs a manual process through the operations console while recording every step as structured data.

1. Operations selects a carrier and service for the parcel, using a maintained rate card or a written quotation.
2. Operations records the quote, books the shipment by phone, email or carrier portal, and enters the booking reference.
3. The platform generates a label and manifest with order, sub-order, parcel and supplier references.
4. At handover, operations records time, weight, dimensions, condition and a photograph.
5. Operations updates shipment status from a daily status file or a phone call. Every update records source and timestamp.
6. On delivery, operations attaches proof of delivery: photo, signature, code or carrier confirmation.
7. Exceptions use a controlled reason code list: address, unavailable, refused, damaged, lost, carrier delay, supplier delay.
8. Claims and carrier invoices are matched to shipment records.

Design requirement: manual coordination is a first-class provider implementation, not a temporary hack. The same shipment record and event history must be used when an API carrier is added.

7.5 WF-05: Integrated logistics (Mode B)

A carrier adapter exposes a common capability set: quote, book, cancel, label, track, proof of delivery and claim. The platform asks the provider which capabilities it supports and degrades gracefully when one is missing.

- **Quote:** request by origin, destination, weight, dimensions and declared value; response includes price, currency, transit time and expiry.
- **Book:** idempotent request with the platform shipment reference; response includes waybill and label.
- **Track:** webhook where available, polling where not; events are normalised into platform status codes.
- **Proof of delivery:** document or code attached to the shipment, with timestamp and recipient evidence.
- **Claim:** structured loss or damage claim linked to shipment, evidence and carrier response.

Rule: no carrier-specific field may leak into the core order model. Provider-specific payloads are stored as adapter metadata, not as columns that every other module must understand.

7.6 WF-06: Returns, refunds and disputes

1. Customer requests a return within the published window, selecting a reason and uploading evidence where required.

2. The platform checks eligibility: delivered date, item category, condition, prior returns and whether the item is excluded.
3. Support or an automated rule approves, rejects or requests more evidence. High-value or disputed cases escalate.
4. If approved, the platform books reverse logistics or instructs a drop-off, and records the return shipment.
5. The supplier or operations inspects the item and records the outcome: resellable, damaged, missing parts, not the ordered item.
6. The refund is calculated from the item value and the applicable delivery share, less any lawful deductions. It cannot exceed the captured amount minus earlier refunds.
7. Finance approves according to threshold, the PSP processes the refund, and the customer is notified at each step.
8. If the cause is the supplier's, the amount is charged back against the supplier's payable, with evidence. If the carrier is responsible, a carrier claim is opened. If the platform is responsible, the platform bears the cost.
9. A dispute remains open until the customer is informed of the outcome and the money movement is complete.

Key rule: a return is not complete when the item is collected; it is complete when inspection, refund and communication are all closed.

7.7 WF-07: Supplier onboarding and KYC

1. Supplier applies with business name, owner identity, TIN, business registration, shop address, contact and category.
2. Supplier uploads documents and accepts the platform agreement, commission terms and service standards.
3. Operations verifies documents, performs a site visit where required, and records evidence.
4. Finance verifies the payout account name against the business identity.
5. The supplier is approved, rejected with reasons, or approved with conditions. Approval creates the store and supplier owner account.
6. Supplier uploads products, which enter moderation before publication.
7. A probation period applies: higher monitoring, lower payout frequency or a hold, according to policy.
8. Re-verification is scheduled periodically and after a material change of ownership, bank account or category.

Data protection: KYC documents are sensitive personal and business data. Access is logged, retention is defined by legal advice, and documents are never placed in a public bucket.

7.8 WF-08: Support and escalation

1. Customer contacts support by phone, WhatsApp, email or a form linked to an order.
2. A ticket is created with order context, category, priority and promised response time.
3. The agent diagnoses using order, payment, shipment and supplier information, without exposing internal notes to the customer.
4. Simple issues are resolved directly. Refunds, supplier penalties and carrier claims follow approval rules.
5. Multi-party disputes link the customer, supplier and carrier records, with evidence and a timeline.
6. Escalation triggers on age, value, repeat contact or a safety issue.
7. Closure requires a resolution code, customer communication and any financial action completed.
8. Repeat causes feed the supplier scorecard and the operations improvement log.

8. Order structure and state model

8.1 Recommended order structure

The marketplace should model five related records, not one flat order:

Record	Purpose	Key fields
Order (parent)	The customer's commercial unit: one checkout, one payment relationship, one support thread, one visible order number	Customer, address snapshot, currency, totals, payment status, aggregate status, policy versions, channel
Supplier order (sub-order)	The fulfilment and settlement unit for one supplier	Supplier, items, merchandise subtotal, discount share, commission, delivery share, status, promised dates, cancellation reason
Order item	The priced line, with a snapshot of product and variant at purchase time	Product and variant references, title and SKU snapshot, quantity, unit price, discount, tax line, commission, return status
Shipment	The physical parcel unit	Carrier, service, waybill, parcel count, weight, dimensions, cost, status, POD, exception reason
Financial entry	The money movement and allocation	Payment, refund, commission, coordination fee, carrier payable, supplier payable, tax, ledger accounts

Recommendation [Proposed]: one checkout creates one parent order and one supplier order per supplier. A supplier order may have one or more shipments; a shipment may contain items from only one supplier. The customer sees the parent order; the platform operates the supplier orders and shipments.

8.2 Why this structure

- **Customer experience:** one order number and one support conversation, even when three parcels arrive on different days.
- **Supplier isolation:** each supplier sees only its own sub-order and the customer data needed to fulfil it.
- **Financial correctness:** commission, refunds and payouts are calculated per supplier order, which is the only level at which liability and settlement make sense.
- **Operational reality:** parcels, carriers and proof of delivery belong to shipments, not to the parent order.
- **Partial failure:** one supplier can reject or cancel without corrupting the other suppliers' orders or the customer's payment record.

A single order per supplier would force the customer to pay several times and would break the promise of one checkout. A single global status would be unable to express "two parcels delivered, one still in transit". Both alternatives create support and accounting debt.

8.3 Separate state dimensions

A single status enum cannot represent payment, fulfilment, return and dispute at the same time. The system should keep separate, auditable state dimensions and derive the customer-facing summary. **[Proposed]**

Dimension	Example values
Payment status	pending, authorised, paid, failed, partially refunded, refunded, reversed
Supplier order status	awaiting acceptance, accepted, preparing, ready for handover, in transit, delivered, completed, cancelled, return in progress, returned
Shipment status	pending, booked, picked up, in transit, at hub, out for delivery, delivered, failed attempt, returned to sender, lost, damaged
Return status	requested, approved, rejected, in transit back, received, inspected, refund pending, refunded, closed
Dispute status	open, investigating, awaiting evidence, resolved, escalated, closed

The customer-facing summary is a projection: for example, “Partially delivered” when one supplier order is delivered and another is in transit. It is computed, not manually set.

8.4 Transition authority

From	To	Who may trigger	Guard
Payment pending	Paid	System after verified PSP status	Signature valid; amount and reference match; order committed
Payment pending	Failed	System after PSP failure or timeout	No order fulfilment started; stock released
Awaiting acceptance	Accepted	Supplier owner or staff	Stock confirmed; within acceptance window
Awaiting acceptance	Rejected	Supplier owner or staff	Reason code required; line refund initiated
Accepted	Preparing	Supplier	No guard beyond assignment
Preparing	Ready for handover	Supplier	Label generated; packing checklist complete
Ready for handover	Handed over	Operations or carrier	Manifest and handover evidence recorded
Handed over	In transit	Carrier event or operations	Tracking reference present
In transit	Out for delivery	Carrier event or operations	Destination hub reached
Out for delivery	Delivered	Carrier event or operations	POD evidence recorded
Out for delivery	Failed attempt	Carrier or operations	Reason code required; retry policy applied
Delivered	Completed	System after return window	No open return or dispute
Any pre-delivery	Cancelled	Customer before acceptance; operations with reason after	Refund and stock release rules apply
Delivered or completed	Return requested	Customer within window	Eligibility rules pass
Return approved	Refund pending	Support or finance	Inspection outcome recorded
Refund pending	Refunded	Finance and PSP	Approval threshold met; PSP confirms

From	To	Who may trigger	Guard
Any	Disputed	Customer, support or finance	Dispute record opened; payout hold applied

Rule: no role may set an arbitrary status directly. Every change is a command with a guard, a reason where required, and an audit event. The database should reject invalid transitions even if a user interface bug tries to make one.

8.5 Edge cases that must be specified before build

Case	Required behaviour
Customer pays, then closes browser before callback	Order is created from the verified server-side status; customer receives confirmation; no duplicate order on retry
Duplicate payment callback	Second callback is idempotent; no duplicate ledger entry or order
Supplier accepts, then finds stock missing	Supplier must request cancellation with reason; customer is informed and refunded for that line; supplier scorecard records it
One supplier rejects, others accept	Parent order remains; rejected line refunded; delivery fee recalculated or partially refunded according to policy
Two parcels, one delivered, one lost	Parent shows partial delivery; lost parcel triggers carrier claim and customer remedy without freezing the delivered item’s completion
Customer returns one item from a multi-item supplier order	Refund is calculated per line plus the applicable delivery share; commission is reversed on that line
Price changes after order placement	Order item snapshot is authoritative; new price applies only to future orders
Supplier is suspended with open orders	Open orders must be fulfilled, reassigned or cancelled under an operations runbook; payouts may be held
Refund after payout	Platform records a negative supplier balance or future deduction; it does not silently reduce an unrelated payout without a statement
Chargeback or reversal after settlement	Finance opens a case, freezes future payouts if needed, and records the loss against the responsible party where evidence supports it

9. Business rules catalogue

The rules below are the bridge between business intent and testable requirements. **Status** shows whether the rule is confirmed by the brief, assumed from the concept, proposed here, or still open.

ID	Rule	Rationale / source	Status
BR-001	One checkout creates one parent order and one supplier order per supplier.	Customer sees one order; platform operates many (concept 7.3)	Proposed
BR-002	Stock is reserved when a payment intent is created and released if payment fails or the reservation expires.	Prevents overselling without holding stock indefinitely	Proposed
BR-003	Prices and totals are calculated server-side from current product and fee records; the browser total is never authoritative.	Prevents tampering and price drift	Proposed
BR-004	Commission is calculated per order line on net merchandise value after line discounts and returns, not on the gross amount captured.	Honest revenue (concept 9.1)	Proposed
BR-005	The customer delivery charge, the carrier charge and the platform coordination fee are recorded as separate amounts.	Prevents pass-through money being counted as revenue	Proposed
BR-006	A refund may include the item value and the applicable delivery share; change-of-mind refunds may exclude delivery.	Fairness and published policy	Open
BR-007	A supplier payout is held until delivery plus the return window, unless a dispute or risk flag extends the hold.	Protects customers and the platform	Proposed
BR-008	A supplier cannot mark an order delivered; delivery requires carrier or operations evidence.	Separation of duties and proof	Proposed
BR-009	Every financial adjustment requires a reason code, an actor and a second approver above a threshold.	Auditability and fraud control	Proposed
BR-010	A product is visible only after moderation approval and while stock is above zero.	Catalogue quality and customer trust	Proposed
BR-011	Placing an order snapshots the product title, SKU, price, tax line and commission rule; later edits do not change the order.	Reproducible invoices and disputes	Proposed
BR-012	A customer may cancel before supplier acceptance; after acceptance, cancellation becomes a return request subject to policy.	Operational reality	Proposed
BR-013	A supplier sees only the customer data required to pack and hand over: name, phone, address, landmark and order items.	Data minimisation and disintermediation control	Proposed
BR-014	Reviews are accepted only from verified purchasers, one review per purchased line, and are moderated for abuse rather than disagreement.	Trust (concept 8.7)	Proposed
BR-015	Prohibited items are blocked at listing and removed at moderation; a supplier that relists them is suspended.	Legal and brand risk	Proposed
BR-016	Every shipment records carrier, service, waybill, cost, weight, dimensions, status events and POD.	Claims and reconciliation	Proposed
BR-017	Failed delivery attempts follow a published retry policy; the customer is contacted before a second attempt.	First-attempt success and fairness	Proposed
BR-018	The return window starts at delivery, not dispatch, and excludes items marked non-returnable for hygiene or safety reasons where law allows.	Consumer fairness	Open
BR-019	All monetary amounts are stored as integer Tanzanian shillings; rounding rules are explicit and applied once per calculation.	Avoids floating-point money errors	Proposed
BR-020	VAT and other tax lines are stored per invoice line and are configurable; the platform does not assume a tax treatment.	Tax law is unresolved	Open
BR-021	The platform is not an escrow or deposit-taking service and does not hold customer funds in a platform wallet.	Regulatory boundary in the brief	Confirmed
BR-022	Brand, territory, fee and approval rules are configuration with effective dates, not code branches.	Configurable franchise requirement	Confirmed
BR-023	Audit records are append-only and cannot be edited or deleted through the application, including by a super administrator.	Accountability	Proposed

ID	Rule	Rationale / source	Status
BR-024	Personal data is collected for a stated purpose, retained only as long as needed or required, and deleted or anonymised on schedule.	PDPA and minimisation	Proposed
BR-025	Marketing consent is separate from transactional messages and can be withdrawn without closing the account.	Consent quality	Proposed
BR-026	Staff access to customer or supplier data outside normal duties requires a reason and is time-bound and logged.	Insider risk	Proposed
BR-027	A refund cannot exceed the captured amount for the payment minus prior refunds and reversals.	Prevents over-refunding	Proposed
BR-028	A payout batch requires a preparer and a different approver; the approver sees the full statement and exceptions.	Maker-checker	Proposed
BR-029	A supplier with an open dispute, negative balance or unresolved KYC issue may have payouts held with a written reason.	Risk control	Proposed
BR-030	Carrier and supplier performance is measured from system events, not from manual opinion, and is visible to the party concerned.	Fair scorecards	Proposed
BR-031	The platform must be able to operate a shipment manually with the same records used by an API carrier.	Carrier-agnostic pilot	Confirmed
BR-032	A customer can obtain a human response within the published support hours; automated replies do not close a ticket.	Trust and consumer care	Proposed

10. Non-functional requirements (draft)

10.1 Approach

Non-functional requirements are written as measurable statements with a verification method. Targets marked **[Proposed]** are starting points for the SRS and must be confirmed against budget, hosting choice and device evidence. They are not marketing claims.

10.2 Requirements

ID	Category	Requirement	Target	Verification
NFR-P-01	Performance	Customer home, category and product pages load quickly on a mid-range Android phone on 4G	Largest Contentful Paint at 75th percentile within 3.0 seconds	Lighthouse and field measurement
NFR-P-02	Performance	Core read APIs respond quickly under pilot load	95th percentile within 500 ms, excluding third-party calls	Load test with production-like data
NFR-P-03	Performance	Write APIs complete predictably	95th percentile within 1,000 ms, excluding PSP or carrier latency	Load test and tracing
NFR-P-04	Performance	Search returns relevant results at pilot catalogue size	95th percentile within 800 ms at 5,000 SKUs	Query benchmark
NFR-P-05	Performance	A customer can complete checkout on a mid-range device	Median under 5 minutes including payment	Moderated usability test
NFR-S-01	Scalability	The pilot supports concurrent browsing and order bursts with headroom	100 concurrent users and 10 checkout submissions per minute, with 5x design headroom	Load test
NFR-S-02	Scalability	The schema and indexes support growth without re-architecture	10x SKUs and 5x order volume over pilot	Design review and synthetic data test
NFR-A-01	Availability	Catalogue, checkout and order APIs are available during support hours	99.5% monthly, excluding announced maintenance	Uptime monitoring
NFR-R-01	Reliability	Payment and order operations survive retries without duplication	Idempotent initiation and callback; zero duplicate orders in test	Integration and chaos tests
NFR-R-02	Reliability	Data can be recovered after failure	Recovery point within 15 minutes; recovery time within 4 hours	Restore drill
NFR-R-03	Reliability	Background jobs retry safely and surface dead letters	At-least-once delivery with idempotent handlers; alert on failures	Job failure injection

ID	Category	Requirement	Target	Verification
NFR-SEC-01	Security	Authentication, checkout and admin meet a recognised application security baseline	OWASP ASVS Level 2 for in-scope controls	Security review and penetration test
NFR-SEC-02	Security	Traffic is encrypted and secrets are protected	TLS 1.2 or higher; secrets in managed store; no secrets in logs	Configuration review and scan
NFR-SEC-03	Security	Passwords and staff authentication resist compromise	Argon2id hashing; MFA required for staff and suppliers	Code review and test
NFR-SEC-04	Security	Authorisation is enforced server-side on every request	Deny-by-default; tenant scoping; automated authorisation tests for every role	Test suite and manual review
NFR-SEC-05	Security	Abuse is rate-limited	Login 5 attempts per minute per IP; OTP 3 per 10 minutes per number; checkout 10 per minute per user	Configuration test
NFR-SEC-06	Security	Uploads cannot become an attack vector	Type and size limits; malware scan; private storage; signed access	Upload tests
NFR-PRIV-01	Privacy	Consent and privacy notices are recorded and enforceable	Versioned notice; consent per purpose; withdrawal honoured	Process and data audit
NFR-PRIV-02	Privacy	Personal data is minimised in logs and interfaces	No card data; PII masked by default; access logged	Log inspection and role tests
NFR-PRIV-03	Privacy	Data subject requests can be fulfilled	Export, correction and deletion workflow within the statutory period to be confirmed	Tabletop exercise with counsel
NFR-AUD-01	Audit	Sensitive actions are traceable	100% of role, refund, payout, price and supplier-status changes logged with actor, reason and before/after	Audit coverage test
NFR-AUD-02	Audit	Audit records resist tampering	Append-only storage; separate access; retention per legal advice	Design review and access test
NFR-M-01	Maintainability	Critical modules have automated tests	At least 70% unit coverage on order, payment, commission and refund logic; integration tests for PSP and carrier adapters	CI report
NFR-M-02	Maintainability	Database changes are controlled	Versioned migrations; tested rollback; no manual production schema edits	Migration review

ID	Category	Requirement	Target	Verification
NFR-M-03	Maintainability	Code and decisions are documented	Architecture decision records; API specification generated from source; runbooks for operations	Documentation review
NFR-OBS-01	Observability	Failures are visible before customers report them	Structured logs with request IDs; error tracking; uptime and payment-success alerts; dashboards	Incident drill
NFR-ACC-01	Accessibility	Critical customer flows are usable with assistive technology	WCAG 2.1 AA for catalogue, cart, checkout and order tracking	Accessibility audit
NFR-I18N-01	Localisation	The interface works in Swahili and English	Swahili default; all strings externalised; TZS formatting; no hard-coded copy	Content review and pseudo-localisation test
NFR-COMP-01	Compatibility	The site works on the devices customers actually use	Current Chrome, Safari, Firefox and Android WebView; graceful degradation on older devices	Device lab and analytics
NFR-SUP-01	Supportability	Support can find any order quickly	Order lookup by number, phone, supplier or tracking reference in under 30 seconds	Usability test with support staff

10.3 Capacity assumptions

Dimension	Pilot assumption	Design headroom	Source
Registered customers	10,000	50,000	Planning assumption
Active suppliers	40	200	Concept Section 8.5
Active SKUs	1,200	12,000	Concept Section 8.5
Orders per month at month 6	900	4,500	Concept Section 3.4
Peak checkout submissions	10 per minute	50 per minute	Planning assumption
Concurrent browsing users	100	500	Planning assumption
Product images per SKU	5	10	Catalogue standard
Shipment events per parcel	6	12	Carrier process

10.4 Retention and audit questions

- How long must KYC documents, invoices, payment records and audit logs be retained under Tanzanian law? **[Open — counsel and accountant]**

- Must personal data be stored in Tanzania, or is a cross-border transfer mechanism acceptable? **[Open — counsel]**
- What is the statutory timeline for responding to a data subject request and for notifying a breach? **[Open — counsel]**
- Are there sector-specific record-keeping rules for payments or courier services that apply to the marketplace? **[Open — counsel]**

Until these are answered, the design should support configurable retention, export and deletion rather than hard-coding a period.

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11. Regulatory and compliance drivers

11.1 Caveat

This section identifies design drivers, not legal conclusions. The sources are official pages or professional summaries, and several apply to the platform only after counsel confirms the platform's role. Every row marked **[Open]** requires a written opinion or a regulator's guidance before launch.

11.2 Compliance register

ID	Area	What the platform must be able to do	Why it may apply	Status / source
REG-01	Data protection (PDPA 2022, PDPC)	Publish a privacy notice; record consent; honour access, correction and deletion requests; secure data; appoint a contact; register where required	The platform collects customer, supplier and KYC data	Open; S14, S15
REG-02	Consumer contracts (FCC Standard Form Regulations 2014)	Publish plain-language terms, returns and delivery policies; retain versions; give a copy at checkout; provide redress	Standard-form consumer contracts and e-commerce terms	Open; S16
REG-03	Electronic transactions (Electronic Transactions Act 2015)	Keep reliable electronic records and audit trails; support electronic acceptance and signatures where used	Orders, contracts and notices are electronic	Open; S19
REG-04	Payment services (Bank of Tanzania)	Collect and settle through an authorised provider; keep pass-through money separate from revenue; do not operate an informal escrow or wallet	The platform collects customer money and pays suppliers	Open; S6
REG-05	Courier and postal services (TCRA)	Use licensed carriers; define whether the platform is a coordinator or a carrier; keep shipment records	Parcel delivery is central to the promise	Open; S17
REG-06	VAT (TRA)	Register if threshold is met; calculate and display tax correctly; issue compliant invoices; keep records	Commission, delivery and subscription revenue may be taxable	Open; S11
REG-07	Corporate income tax (TRA)	Produce accurate revenue, cost and profit records; support filings	The operating company is taxable	Open; S12
REG-08	Company, business names and trademarks (BRELA)	Register the company and marks; record any brand licence; protect the platform name	Brand and franchise layer	Open; S13

ID	Area	What the platform must be able to do	Why it may apply	Status / source
REG-09	Fair competition	Avoid resale price maintenance and anti-competitive exclusivity; keep supplier terms transparent	Supplier agreements and promotions	Open
REG-10	Consumer protection and product safety	Honour warranties and returns; remove prohibited or unsafe goods; keep evidence of supplier declarations	Customer trust and legal exposure	Open
REG-11	Franchise and brand licence	Record the licence scope, territory, fees, quality controls, termination and IP ownership; do not imply a relationship that does not exist	Proposed Usiri relationship	Open; S13
REG-12	Insurance and liability	Record carrier liability terms and insurance evidence; define who bears loss, damage and injury	Parcels and products	Open

11.3 Data protection requirements that affect the design

1. **Purpose limitation.** Each data field has a stated purpose. KYC data is not reused for marketing.
2. **Lawful basis.** Contract is the basis for order fulfilment; consent is the basis for marketing; legal obligation covers tax and fraud records. Counsel must confirm.
3. **Minimisation.** Suppliers and carriers receive only the fields needed to perform their task, not the whole customer record.
4. **Retention.** Retention is configurable and documented per data class. Deletion must not break financial or audit obligations.
5. **Processor agreements.** The PSP, SMS provider, cloud host, support tool and analytics provider must be bound by written data-processing terms.
6. **Security.** Encryption in transit and at rest, access control, logging and breach response are part of the compliance obligation, not only engineering good practice.
7. **Rights.** A customer can request a copy, correction or deletion of personal data through a documented process, with identity verification.
8. **Cross-border transfer.** Hosting and backup locations must be chosen with counsel, not by accident.

11.4 The payment and escrow boundary

The brief is explicit: the platform must not assume it holds customer funds in escrow. The design therefore separates four things:

- **Collection:** the PSP collects from the customer under the platform’s merchant account.
- **Platform revenue:** commission, coordination fee and subscription, recognised when earned.
- **Supplier payable:** a contractual debt owed by the platform to the supplier after the payout hold, not a segregated customer deposit.
- **Carrier payable:** a cost owed to the carrier under its invoice.

Whether this structure requires a payment licence, a specific PSP marketplace product, or a different legal form is an **[Open]** question for counsel and the PSP. The software must not describe itself as escrow, trust account or wallet unless the legal structure supports that description.

11.5 Consumer terms and returns

The platform must publish, version and present at checkout:

- Terms of service and the role of the marketplace versus the supplier.
- Delivery promise, zones, fees and failed-delivery policy.
- Return and refund policy, including exclusions and who pays reverse transport.
- Warranty and product-safety position.
- Complaints and dispute process, with response times.
- Privacy notice and consent choices.

The FCC standard-form contract and consumer-protection position must be reviewed before launch. The software should store the exact policy version accepted by each customer at checkout.

11.6 Tax and invoicing

The platform must be able to:

- Store tax rates and tax amounts per line, with effective dates.
- Distinguish marketplace commission, delivery coordination, subscription and sponsored revenue.
- Produce a customer receipt and a supplier statement that reconcile to the ledger.
- Export data in a form the accountant can use for VAT and corporate tax filings.
- Support electronic fiscal receipt or invoicing requirements if advised.
- Handle withholding tax on franchise or royalty payments if advised.

No tax rate or treatment is hard-coded before the accountant confirms it.

11.7 Franchise and intellectual property

If a brand licence or franchise is agreed, the system must support:

- Licensed marks and assets with usage rules and expiry.
- Territory and channel restrictions.
- Fee and royalty records, including withholding tax treatment.
- Brand approval workflow for campaigns and storefront presentation.
- Quality and compliance reporting to the licensor.
- Termination and wind-down: export of data, removal of marks, continuity for customers.

If no licence is agreed, these capabilities remain inactive configuration. The platform must not display Usiri marks, imply endorsement or describe itself as a Usiri company.

11.8 Questions for counsel and the accountant

1. Does the platform’s collection-and-settlement model require a payment service licence, or is it covered by the PSP’s authorisation?
2. What registrations and filings apply under the PDPA, including controller or processor registration and a data protection officer?

3. Is the standard-form consumer contract registrable with the FCC, and what must be filed?
4. Does the platform need a courier or postal licence if it coordinates but does not physically carry parcels?
5. When does VAT registration apply, and how should commission, delivery and subscription revenue be treated?
6. What records must be kept for tax, how long, and in what format?
7. Are cross-border hosting and support tools permitted, and what safeguards are required?
8. What are the consumer warranty, return and refund obligations that cannot be contracted away?
9. What are the competition-law limits on supplier exclusivity, minimum pricing and promotions?
10. If a franchise or brand licence is signed, how should fees, royalties and withholding tax be documented and recorded?

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12. Confirmed, assumed, proposed and open

12.1 Confirmed requirements and constraints

ID	Item
C-01	The application is a multi-vendor marketplace connecting customers, suppliers, the operator, carriers and payment providers.
C-02	The founders intend to own the operating company and the technology.
C-03	A franchise or brand arrangement with Usiri is proposed, not agreed.
C-04	No Usiri API is assumed to exist; the logistics module must support Usiri or alternatives.
C-05	The logistics design must be provider-agnostic and support manual and API modes.
C-06	Franchise, branding and operating rules must be configurable.
C-07	The platform does not assume it holds customer funds in escrow.
C-08	Payment integration must use appropriately authorised providers.
C-09	Confirmed, assumed, proposed and unresolved items must be clearly separated.
C-10	The engineering work follows the document sequence and requires review before implementation.

12.2 Assumptions carried from the concept

ID	Assumption	Consequence if wrong
A-01	Pilot city is Dar es Salaam.	Zones, delivery pricing and operations change
A-02	Initial assortment is home, kitchen and small electrical goods in the TZS 30,000–250,000 band.	Catalogue model, attributes and delivery handling change
A-03	25–40 verified suppliers at launch.	Onboarding capacity and catalogue size change
A-04	900 completed orders in pilot month 6.	Capacity and support staffing change
A-05	Commission hypothesis is 8%, tested between 6% and 12%.	Revenue model and supplier terms change
A-06	Customer delivery charge is around TZS 5,000 per order.	Checkout conversion and contribution change
A-07	Return window is 7 days from delivery.	Refund holds and policy text change
A-08	Supplier payout after delivery plus the return window.	Cash flow and supplier willingness change
A-09	Support hours are 09:00–18:00, Monday to Saturday.	SLA and staffing change

ID	Assumption	Consequence if wrong
A-10	A 30-day functional guarantee applies to eligible goods.	Returns and supplier terms change
A-11	Logistics is manual at pilot, with API as an upgrade.	Build scope and carrier selection change
A-12	Interface is Swahili-first with English.	Content and testing effort change
A-13	Customer channel is a responsive web app or PWA.	Native app scope appears
A-14	MVP build is 8–12 weeks with a dedicated technical lead and one developer.	Timeline and cost change
A-15	One legal entity operates the marketplace and holds the contracts.	Multi-entity settlement and tax change

12.3 Proposed design decisions

ID	Proposal	Where it appears
P-01	Parent order plus supplier orders plus shipments plus order items.	Section 8
P-02	Separate payment, fulfilment, return and dispute state dimensions.	Section 8.3
P-03	Double-entry ledger for all money movements.	Section 7.3
P-04	Role-based access with tenant scoping and field masking.	Section 5
P-05	Carrier adapter with capability discovery and manual fallback.	Section 7.5
P-06	Payment confirmation only from verified PSP callbacks and server-side status.	Section 7.3
P-07	Maker-checker for payouts, refunds above threshold and role changes.	Section 5.5
P-08	Catalogue moderation before publication and stock suppression at zero.	Section 9
P-09	Verified-buyer reviews only.	Section 9
P-10	Documentation packs and stage gates before implementation.	Section 17

12.4 Open items

ID	Open item	Owner	Needed by
O-01	Franchise fee, royalty, territory, term, termination and brand assets	Founders and counsel	Before any brand commitment
O-02	Domain name, trademark search and brand ownership	Founders and counsel	Before public launch

ID	Open item	Owner	Needed by
O-03	PSP selection, fees, settlement product and contract	Finance lead	Before payment build
O-04	Carrier selection, rates, liability, insurance and API capability	Operations lead	Before logistics build
O-05	Final commission, subscription and delivery pricing	Founders after supplier research	Before supplier contracts
O-06	Cash on delivery: offered or not	Founders and finance	Before checkout design freeze
O-07	Return window and exclusions	Founders, counsel and suppliers	Before policy publication
O-08	Payout cadence and hold period	Finance and suppliers	Before settlement build
O-09	VAT, invoicing and withholding treatment	Accountant	Before ledger finalisation
O-10	PDPA registration, DPO and cross-border transfer position	Counsel	Before production data
O-11	FCC filing and consumer terms	Counsel	Before launch
O-12	Courier licensing position	Counsel	Before carrier contracts
O-13	Support hours, channels and SLA	Operations	Before pilot
O-14	Hosting region, budget and vendor	CTO and founders	Before architecture sign-off
O-15	Team skills, hiring and outsourcing	Founders	Before roadmap commitment
O-16	Launch date and pilot supplier cohort	Founders and operations	Before Phase 2 gate

13. Missing information and discovery plan

13.1 Evidence gaps

ID	Missing information	Why it matters	How to obtain it	Impact if unresolved
GAP-01	Customer willingness to pay a delivery fee and buy these categories online	Determines whether demand exists at the modelled price	30 interviews, 150 survey responses, 8 mystery shops	No defensible demand case; checkout and pricing assumptions are guesses
GAP-02	Supplier willingness to accept commission, subscription and service standards	Determines supply and unit economics	15 interviews, 5 site visits, written indications	Commission and catalogue plan cannot be set; suppliers may refuse
GAP-03	Carrier rates, transit times, liability and API capability	Determines delivery cost, promise and integration mode	Three written quotations, sample shipments, terms review	Delivery promise cannot be costed; manual process may be the only option
GAP-04	PSP merchant terms, fees, settlement and refund capabilities	Determines payment architecture and cash flow	Two proposals, sandbox tests, contract review	Payment build cannot start; settlement model may not be supported
GAP-05	Franchise or brand terms	Determines branding, fees and approval workflow	Written term sheet and counsel review	Brand configuration remains speculative; no marks may be used
GAP-06	Legal position on payments, data, consumer contracts and courier coordination	Determines whether the model can operate as designed	Written counsel memo	Launch may be blocked or require redesign
GAP-07	Tax treatment and invoicing requirements	Determines ledger, receipts and reporting	Accountant ruling	Incorrect invoices and tax filings; retrofit cost
GAP-08	KYC document standard and verification process	Determines supplier onboarding and fraud control	Counsel and compliance adviser	Weak supplier verification; regulatory and fraud exposure
GAP-09	Market return and warranty norms	Determines policy and refund reserves	Competitor policy review, supplier interviews	Return rate and contribution assumptions may be wrong
GAP-10	Address quality and last-mile practice	Determines zone design, failed-delivery rate and support load	50 address tests, carrier data, field observation	Delivery promise and cost may be unrealistic
GAP-11	Device, browser and network profile of target customers	Determines performance budget and front-end choices	Landing-page analytics, TCRA data, usability tests	Performance targets may be wrong; exclusion of low-end users
GAP-12	Supplier photography and content capacity	Determines catalogue quality and moderation load	Supplier audit, sample content	Poor listings, high returns, moderation bottleneck
GAP-13	Support contact volume and handling time	Determines staffing and SLA	Pilot time-and-motion, competitor benchmarks	Understaffed support; broken promise
GAP-14	Insurance and liability cover	Determines who bears loss, damage and injury	Broker quotations and carrier terms	Uninsured exposure; disputes with carriers
GAP-15	Hosting and data residency options	Determines architecture and compliance	Cloud proposals, counsel advice	Late re-platforming or compliance breach
GAP-16	Startup and operating budget, runway	Determines scope, team and timeline	Founders' financial plan and workbook	Roadmap is unaffordable; key work stops
GAP-17	Team skills and availability	Determines build versus buy and timeline	Skills audit, references, trial task	Missed milestones; poor code quality
GAP-18	Brand and trademark availability	Determines name, domain and legal exposure	BRELA search and counsel	Rebranding after launch; infringement risk

13.2 Evidence standards

Evidence	Minimum standard	Who owns it
Customer demand	30 recorded interviews, 150 survey responses, 8 mystery shops with screenshots and timestamps	Research lead
Supplier supply	15 interviews, 5 site visits, product and price lists, written indication of commission acceptance	Research lead and operations
Carrier capability	3 written quotations, rate cards, sample shipment results, liability and insurance terms	Operations lead
Payment capability	2 written PSP proposals, sandbox test results, settlement and refund terms	Finance lead
Legal and tax	Written counsel memo and accountant ruling on the questions in Section 11.8	Founders
Franchise	Written term sheet or a clear written decline	Founders
Technical feasibility	Spike of the riskiest integration, not a full build	CTO

13.3 Research sequence

1. **Legal and payment boundary first.** If the collection-and-settlement model cannot be lawfully operated with an available PSP, the product design changes fundamentally. Do this before UI work.
2. **Carrier and supplier quotes second.** These determine delivery cost, promise and catalogue scope.
3. **Customer demand third.** Willingness to pay is tested with a landing page and interviews, not with a full build.
4. **Franchise conversation only when the evidence pack is ready.** Do not approach Usiri with an unfunded idea and no operating plan.
5. **Architecture spike last.** Prove the PSP callback, the multi-supplier order split and the carrier adapter with a thin technical spike, not a full application.

13.4 What must not be built yet

- A production checkout before the PSP and legal structure are confirmed.
- A carrier integration before a carrier agreement and API documentation exist.
- A franchise-branded interface before a written licence exists.
- A supplier payout engine before the settlement and tax treatment are confirmed.
- A native app before the web pilot proves demand.
- A recommendation engine, wallet or loyalty scheme before there is data and a licensed model.

14. Decisions required from the founders

The first four decisions blocked the BRD and SRS; they were answered on 30 October 2026 and are marked below. The rest can be resolved during requirements elaboration, but each has a default so that work is not stalled.

ID	Decision	Options and recommended default	Impact	Status
DEC-01	Launch scope	**Recommended:** Dar es Salaam, home, kitchen and small electrical goods, TZS 30,000–250,000, 25–40 suppliers. Alternatives: broader general merchandise, electronics-first, multi-city	Sets catalogue, delivery, supplier and compliance scope	**Decided 30 Oct 2026 — general merchandise**, six bounded departments, 40 suppliers, 800–1,200 SKUs. Recommendation not taken; see UM-AMD-001
DEC-02	Fulfilment model	**Recommended:** supplier-held stock, platform-coordinated pickup or drop-off, no warehouse or fleet. Alternatives: marketplace hub, supplier self-delivery, dropship	Sets logistics module, cost and control	**Decided 30 Oct 2026 — as recommended**
DEC-03	Payment and settlement	**Recommended:** licensed PSP collects; platform settles suppliers after delivery plus return window, with holds and maker-checker. Alternatives: split settlement at capture, cash on delivery, hybrid	Sets payment architecture, cash flow and legal review	**Decided 30 Oct 2026 — as recommended**
DEC-04	Build route	**Recommended:** custom modular monolith (Next.js, FastAPI, PostgreSQL) with an 8–12 week MVP and a dedicated technical lead. Alternatives: hosted marketplace first, hybrid, longer part-time build	Sets budget, team, timeline and control	**Decided 30 Oct 2026 — as recommended; 8–12 weeks recorded as a stretch target, with a week-8 scope gate**
DEC-05	Order structure	**Recommended:** parent order plus supplier orders plus shipments plus items	Determines the core data model and all financial logic	Proposed; confirm in SRS
DEC-06	State model	**Recommended:** separate payment, fulfilment, return and dispute dimensions, with a derived customer summary	Prevents an unmanageable single status enum	Proposed; confirm in SRS
DEC-07	Commission and fees	Start with the 8% hypothesis, configurable and effective-dated; final rate after supplier research	Revenue and supplier contracts	Open; resolve before contracts
DEC-08	Return and payout policy	7-day return window; payout after delivery plus window; exceptions for disputes	Cash flow, policy text and customer trust	Open; resolve before build freeze
DEC-09	Logistics mode	Manual Mode A at pilot; adapter contract designed now; API only with a capable carrier	Build scope and carrier dependency	Proposed; confirm
DEC-10	Brand and franchise configuration	Build the configuration capability but keep it inactive until a written licence exists	Prevents implied affiliation and rework	Confirmed direction
DEC-11	Hosting and data location	Managed cloud with a region chosen after counsel advice; no hard-coded vendor	Compliance, cost and operations	Open; resolve before architecture
DEC-12	Language and support	Swahili default, English available; support 09:00–18:00 Monday to Saturday at pilot	Content, staffing and SLA	Proposed; confirm

14.1 Status of the decisions after 30 October 2026

DEC-01 to DEC-04 are closed. Closing DEC-01 created eight sub-decisions, D-13 to D-20, recorded in the decision log and the amendment: the exact department tree, the minimum delivered basket, the category commission schedule, beauty authenticity evidence, baby safety declaration, the fashion return policy, the launch

supplier cohort, and the timeline fallback. Four of them — D-16, D-17, D-18 and D-20 — must be answered before the related category goes live or before the week-8 gate. None blocks starting the BRD.

14.2 Decision process

1. Founders read this report and the concept document.
2. Each founder records an independent view on DEC-01 to DEC-04 before the meeting.
3. The group discusses differences, not preferences, and records the decision, the reason and the dissent in the decision log.
4. A decision is not final until its evidence implications are accepted. For example, choosing a PSP is not a decision to integrate before counsel confirms the model.
5. Decisions are versioned. A later change requires a new entry, not a silent edit.

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15. Initial delivery risk register

Scores use likelihood 1–5 and impact 1–5; the score is the product. These are planning assessments, not measured probabilities.

ID	Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Score	Mitigation	Trigger
RSK-01	Scope creep turns the MVP into a full marketplace	4	4	16	Strict scope rule; change board; defer list	New feature requested without a pilot-order justification
RSK-02	PSP onboarding or integration takes longer than planned	4	4	16	Start PSP conversations before build; sandbox spike; alternative provider identified	No sandbox access within two weeks
RSK-03	Carrier cannot provide rates, tracking or liability terms	4	4	16	Manual mode by default; qualify a second carrier; written terms before pilot	No rate card or tracking sample by Phase 2
RSK-04	Multi-supplier order logic is underestimated	3	5	15	Design parent/ sub-order model first; test partial acceptance and partial refund	First sprint cannot model a three-supplier order
RSK-05	Payment reconciliation errors create supplier distrust	3	5	15	Double-entry ledger; daily reconciliation; exception queue; finance sign-off	More than 0.5% unmatched transactions in test
RSK-06	Personal data breach or unlawful processing	3	5	15	PDPA review; minimisation; encryption; access control; incident plan	Any confirmed unauthorised access
RSK-07	Regulatory position blocks the payment or courier model	3	5	15	Counsel memo before build; PSP guidance; fallback model	Counsel identifies a licensing requirement not covered by the PSP
RSK-08	Key-person dependency on one developer	4	4	16	Documentation; code review; second contributor; repository access	One person holds all production access

ID	Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Score	Mitigation	Trigger
RSK-09	Suppliers do not adopt the portal or keep stock accurate	4	4	16	Simple onboarding; CSV upload; WhatsApp support; stock audits; scorecard	Fewer than 60% of suppliers update stock weekly in pilot
RSK-10	Cost overrun exhausts the pilot budget	3	4	12	Lean scope; fixed-price where possible; monthly burn review; stop rules	Burn exceeds plan by 20% for two months
RSK-11	Franchise dependency distorts priorities or brand use	3	3	9	No dependency in critical path; written licence only; fallback brand	Team waits for Usiri instead of testing demand
RSK-12	Support volume overwhelms the small team	3	4	12	Self-service order tracking; canned responses; SLA triage; exception codes	More than 20% of orders generate a ticket
RSK-13	Payment fraud or friendly fraud	3	4	12	PSP risk tools; velocity limits; verified delivery; evidence for disputes	Chargeback rate above 1% of transactions
RSK-14	Address and delivery failures damage the promise	4	3	12	Landmark capture; phone confirmation; zone design; second attempt	First-attempt success below 70% for two weeks
RSK-15	Poor performance on low-end devices	3	3	9	Performance budget; image optimisation; device testing; CDN	LCP above 4 seconds on target devices

16. Traceability seed

16.1 Objective-to-capability trace

Objective	Capabilities	Key rules	Quality attributes	Acceptance theme	Evidence
OBJ-01 Demand	CAP-05, CAP-06, CAP-07	BR-001, BR-002, BR-003, BR-011	NFR-P-01, NFR-P-04, NFR-P-05	A customer can buy from three suppliers in one checkout	Pilot orders, conversion
OBJ-02 Delivery	CAP-10	BR-016, BR-017, BR-030	NFR-A-01, NFR-R-02	Every parcel has a carrier, waybill, status history and POD	On-time delivery, first-attempt success
OBJ-03 Trust	CAP-11, CAP-12	BR-006, BR-009, BR-014, BR-032	NFR-AUD-01, NFR-PRIV-01	A return is resolved with a refund and a customer communication	Resolution time, CSAT, return rate
OBJ-04 Supply	CAP-01, CAP-02, CAP-03	BR-010, BR-015, BR-029	NFR-SEC-04, NFR-PRIV-02	A supplier is verified, approved, publishes approved products and sees only its own data	Suppliers onboarded, retention
OBJ-05 Economics	CAP-08, CAP-09, CAP-15	BR-004, BR-005, BR-007, BR-027	NFR-M-01, NFR-R-01	Commission, refunds and payouts reconcile to the ledger	Contribution margin, reconciliation rate
OBJ-06 Compliance	CAP-01, CAP-14	BR-020, BR-021, BR-024, BR-025	NFR-PRIV-01, NFR-AUD-02	The platform can evidence consent, terms version, invoices and audit	Legal review, filings
OBJ-07 Operability	CAP-12, CAP-14, CAP-15	BR-009, BR-023, BR-028	NFR-OBS-01, NFR-SUP-01	The team can run a pilot day without shadow spreadsheets	Orders handled in system
OBJ-08 Scale decision	CAP-15, CAP-17	BR-019, BR-030	NFR-S-01, NFR-S-02	Reports show demand, retention, delivery and unit economics by cohort	Month-6 review pack

16.2 How traceability will be maintained

- Every requirement in the SRS will carry an ID such as `REQ-ORD-014`.
- Every requirement will reference at least one objective and one acceptance test.
- Every business rule will be enforced in code, configuration or process, with a test or control evidence.
- Every test case will reference the requirement it proves.
- The matrix will be a living file, reviewed at each stage gate. A requirement without a test is not complete; a test without a requirement is either unnecessary or reveals a missing requirement.

17. Document roadmap and phase gates

17.1 Document packs

Pack	Documents	Purpose	Gate
0. Discovery	This report; decision log; traceability seed	Establish scope, actors, rules and unknowns	G0 scope approval
A. Business	BRD; stakeholder and role matrix; functional requirements catalogue; use cases; user stories and acceptance criteria	Define what the business needs, in testable language	G1 requirements sign-off
B. Technical	SRS; non-functional requirements catalogue; system architecture; database design; API specification; security architecture	Define how the system will be built and controlled	G2 architecture and security review
C. Experience	UI/UX specification; wireframes and prototype; design system; content and localisation guide	Define every major screen and interaction	G3 prototype review
D. Integration	Payment integration specification; logistics integration specification; notification specification	Define external contracts and failure handling	G3 with Pack B
E. Delivery	Testing and QA plan; DevOps and deployment plan; backup and disaster recovery plan; development roadmap; MVP scope; project risk register	Define how the build is delivered and verified	G4 build readiness
F. Implementation	Code, environments, migrations, runbooks, training and pilot operations	Build, test and launch	G5 pilot go/no-go

The 20 documents named in the brief are distributed across these packs. Several are combined where splitting them would create duplication without adding clarity; the intent of the brief is coverage, not bureaucratic count.

17.2 Stage gates

Gate	Entry criteria	Exit criteria	Who decides
G0 Scope	This report complete; founders have read it	DEC-01 to DEC-04 answered; scope boundary accepted	Founders
G1 Requirements	Discovery decisions recorded; evidence gaps have owners	BRD and SRS reviewed; traceability complete for MVP; no unresolved blocking rule	Founders and product owner
G2 Architecture	SRS baseline; PSP and carrier constraints known	Data model, API, security and deployment reviewed; risks accepted	CTO, founders, external reviewer
G3 Experience	Architecture baseline; content plan	Prototype tested with target users; accessibility and localisation checked	Product owner and design lead

Gate	Entry criteria	Exit criteria	Who decides
G4 Build readiness	Architecture and UX approved; team and budget confirmed	Test plan, environments, CI/CD, backup and runbooks ready	CTO and founders
G5 Pilot launch	MVP acceptance criteria met; legal baseline in place; suppliers and carrier ready	Controlled pilot begins with a stop rule	Founders

17.3 Rules

- No production code before G2 and G3 approval. A technical spike is allowed to test a risk, but it is not a product.
- No brand use before a written licence.
- No live payment collection before PSP onboarding and legal review.
- No customer data in production before the privacy notice, retention plan and access controls are in place.
- Any scope change after G1 goes through the change log with cost, risk and schedule impact.
- A decision may be reversed, but only with a new decision-log entry explaining why.

17.4 Immediate next step

After the four blocking decisions are answered, the next document is the **BRD**, followed by the **SRS**. The BRD will restate the business objectives and scope in business language; the SRS will convert the capability map, business rules and non-functional requirements into numbered, testable requirements with use cases and acceptance criteria.

18. Questions for this review round

The questions are deliberately grouped and limited. Each has a recommended default so that the discussion starts from a concrete proposal rather than a blank page.

Answered 30 October 2026. All four groups were put to the founders and answered. The answers are recorded in full in `01_Decision_Log.md` v0.2 and elaborated in `03_Decision_Outcome_and_Scope_Amendment.md` v1.0. The options below are retained as the record of what was considered.

Group	Question	Answer
1	What may the first release sell, where, and to how many suppliers?	**General merchandise**, bounded to six departments in Dar es Salaam; 40 suppliers; 800–1,200 SKUs. The recommendation was not taken.
2	Who holds stock and who moves the parcel?	**Supplier-held stock, platform-coordinated licensed carriers.** As recommended.
3	How is money collected and when are suppliers paid?	**Licensed PSP collects; supplier payout after delivery plus the return window.** As recommended.
4	How is it built, by whom, and in what time?	**Custom modular monolith, technical lead plus one developer, 8–12 weeks** recorded as a stretch target. As recommended, with a week-8 scope gate.

18.1 Group 1: Launch scope

Question: What is the first release allowed to sell, where, and to how many suppliers?

- **Recommended:** Dar es Salaam mainland, home, kitchen and small electrical goods in the TZS 30,000–250,000 band, 25–40 verified suppliers. It matches the concept's evidence, keeps delivery and returns manageable, and gives a coherent reason to visit the site.
- **Alternative A:** Broader general merchandise. It increases choice but dilutes curation, raises return and counterfeit risk, and makes delivery economics harder to predict.
- **Alternative B:** Electronics first. It raises average order value but adds warranty, theft, counterfeit and price-transparency risk before operations are stable.
- **Alternative C:** Multi-city launch. It multiplies operational complexity before the Dar es Salaam promise is proven.

Why it matters: the category determines the product data model, delivery handling, return policy, supplier profile and marketing message. It is expensive to change after the catalogue and supplier agreements exist.

18.2 Group 2: Fulfilment model

Question: Who holds the stock, and who moves the parcel?

- **Recommended:** suppliers hold their own stock; the platform coordinates pickup or drop-off through licensed carriers; no warehouse and no fleet. This preserves the asset-light model and keeps capital within reach.

- **Alternative A:** a marketplace collection hub or dark store. It improves consolidation and control but adds rent, staffing, inventory risk and a new operating location.
- **Alternative B:** supplier self-delivery with platform tracking only. It is cheaper to start but makes the delivery promise inconsistent and hard to enforce.
- **Alternative C:** dropship direct from supplier to customer. It is fast to launch but weakens quality control and the customer experience.

Why it matters: the choice determines the logistics data model, who is liable when a parcel is late or damaged, and whether the platform can promise a consistent delivery window.

18.3 Group 3: Payment and settlement

Question: How is money collected, and when are suppliers paid?

- **Recommended:** a licensed PSP collects the full order amount; the platform records the supplier payable and settles after delivery plus the return window, with holds for disputes and maker-checker approval. This is the clearest boundary between customer money, platform revenue and supplier debt.
- **Alternative A:** split settlement at payment capture, if the PSP supports it. It speeds supplier payment but reduces the platform's ability to handle returns and disputes.
- **Alternative B:** cash on delivery, with commission invoiced to suppliers. It serves customers without mobile money but creates collection, reconciliation and fraud risk.
- **Alternative C:** a hybrid, with prepaid PSP payment as the default and cash on delivery in selected zones. It adds a second money workflow and must not be attempted before the prepaid flow is stable.

Why it matters: it determines the payment integration, ledger, refund process, supplier contract and legal review. It cannot be left to the build team to infer.

18.4 Group 4: Build route

Question: How should the first release be built, and with what team and timeline?

- **Recommended:** a custom modular monolith using Next.js, TypeScript, FastAPI and PostgreSQL, with a dedicated technical lead, one developer and a part-time designer, delivered in 8–12 weeks. It gives control over the multi-supplier order, settlement and carrier adapter, which are the differentiating parts.
- **Alternative A:** a hosted marketplace platform first, customised through plugins. It is faster to a storefront but constrains the order, payout and logistics logic and may add transaction fees.
- **Alternative B:** a hybrid, buying the storefront and payments while building the supplier portal and delivery orchestration. It balances speed and control but creates two systems to integrate.
- **Alternative C:** the same custom build over 16–20 weeks with a part-time team. It reduces cash burn per month but delays learning and increases the risk that the market moves first.

Why it matters: it sets the budget, the hiring plan, the architecture and the amount of custom control over the marketplace's core differentiators.

18.5 After the answers

The answers are recorded in `01_Decision_Log.md` v0.2. The scope consequence is issued as UM-AMD-001 and governs over the scope recommendation in Section 3. The remaining open items are D-13 to D-20 in the amendment, which must be resolved before the relevant part of the BRD, SRS or category go-live. The BRD and SRS are drafted against the amended scope. No code will be written until the architecture and UX packs are reviewed and approved.

Appendix A. Glossary

Term	Meaning in this document
Parent order	The customer’s single commercial order created by one checkout, which may contain several supplier orders
Supplier order (sub-order)	The part of a parent order fulfilled by one supplier; the unit for commission, payout and supplier status
Shipment	A physical parcel or consignment with a carrier, waybill, weight and proof of delivery
GMV	Gross merchandise value: the value of goods sold before deductions
Net merchandise value	Merchandise value after line discounts and returns, before delivery and fees
Take rate	Marketplace revenue divided by gross merchandise value
Contribution	Revenue minus variable costs, before fixed operating costs
PSP	Payment service provider authorised to collect and settle payments
POD	Proof of delivery: photo, signature, code or carrier confirmation
KYC	Know-your-customer checks on a supplier’s identity, ownership and payout account
RBAC	Role-based access control
Maker-checker	A control where one person prepares an action and a different person approves it
Idempotency	The property that repeating the same request does not duplicate the effect
Ledger	The record of every money movement and its allocation to accounts
Reconciliation	Matching the platform’s records to the PSP or carrier statement
SLA	Service-level agreement or target for response, dispatch or resolution
PDPA	Tanzania’s Personal Data Protection Act 2022
PDPC	Personal Data Protection Commission
FCC	Fair Competition Commission
TRA	Tanzania Revenue Authority
BRELA	Business Registrations and Licensing Agency
TCRA	Tanzania Communications Regulatory Authority
BoT	Bank of Tanzania

Appendix B. Source register

This is a subset of the concept document's source register, repeated for the regulatory and partner claims used here. All sources were accessed on 29 October 2026. A source's presence does not mean it has been independently audited.

ID	Publisher	Document	URL
S1	Usiri Group of Companies	About	https://www.usirigroup.co.tz/about
S2	Usiri Group of Companies	Transportation	https://www.usirigroup.co.tz/services/transportation
S4	Usiri Group of Companies	Tracking	https://www.usirigroup.co.tz/track
S6	Bank of Tanzania	National Payment Systems Annual Report 2025	https://www.bot.go.tz/Publications/Regular/Annual%20Report/en/2026060211494565.pdf
S11	TRA	Value Added Tax	https://www.tra.go.tz/page/value-added-tax-vat
S12	PwC	Tanzania — Taxes on corporate income	https://taxsummaries.pwc.com/tanzania/corporate/taxes-on-corporate-income
S13	ZATRA	Franchising Tanzania: Law, Tax and Royalty Guide	https://www.zatra.co/post/franchising-tanzania
S14	DLA Piper	Data protection laws in Tanzania	https://www.dlapiperdataprotection.com/?c=TZ&t=l
S15	Rex Attorneys	PDPC registration deadline	https://rexattorneys.co.tz/portfolio/reminder-to-clients-final-deadline-for-registration-with-the-personal-data-protec pdpc/
S16	Fair Competition Commission	Standard Form (Consumer Contracts) Regulations 2014	https://www.fcc.go.tz/attachments/ attachment-1719186970334-2762257834.%20Standard%20Form%20CONSUMER%20CONTRACTS%20Regu

ID	Publisher	Document	URL
S17	TCRA	Postal services and licensing	https://www.tcra.go.tz/resources/postal-services
S18	TCRA	National Addressing and Postcode	https://www.tcra.go.tz/services/featured/national-adressing-and-postcode
S19	Ministry of Finance	Electronic Transactions Act 2015 (Cap. 442 R.E. 2022)	https://www.mof.go.tz/uploads/documents/en-1676545044-THE%20ELECTRONIC%20TRANSACTIONS%20AC%20CAP%20442%20R.E.%202022.pdf

Software standards referenced as targets, not certifications: OWASP Application Security Verification Standard (ASVS) Level 2 and WCAG 2.1 AA. They are used to make security and accessibility requirements testable; no audit or certification has been obtained.

Appendix C. Document conventions

Convention	Use
OBJ-nn	Business objective
STK-nn	Stakeholder
ROL-nn	Role
CAP-nn	Capability or module
WF-nn	End-to-end workflow
BR-nnn	Business rule
NFR-xxx-nn	Non-functional requirement
REG-nn	Regulatory or compliance driver
C-nn / A-nn / P-nn / O-nn	Confirmed, assumed, proposed, open
GAP-nn	Missing information or evidence gap
DEC-nn	Decision required
RSK-nn	Delivery risk
REQ-xxx-nnn	Requirement in the SRS, assigned later
AT-nn	Acceptance test theme, expanded in the test plan

All monetary figures in this report are Tanzanian shillings unless stated otherwise. All dates are 2026 unless stated otherwise. Any figure described as a target is a hypothesis until measured.